

Auto Mode Detection & Chat Scope

How the chat picks its own mode, and how the user picks global vs module context.

The two things you are designing

These are **two different controls**. Mixing them into one will confuse your design. Keep them separate in the UI.

Control	What it controls	Who decides
Mode normal / query / workflow	What the AI <i>does</i>	AI decides automatically
Scope global / module	What data the AI <i>looks at</i>	User decides

Part 1 — Auto mode (no mode switcher)

Removing the mode switcher is the right call. Users should not have to learn three modes. But there is one rule you must follow.

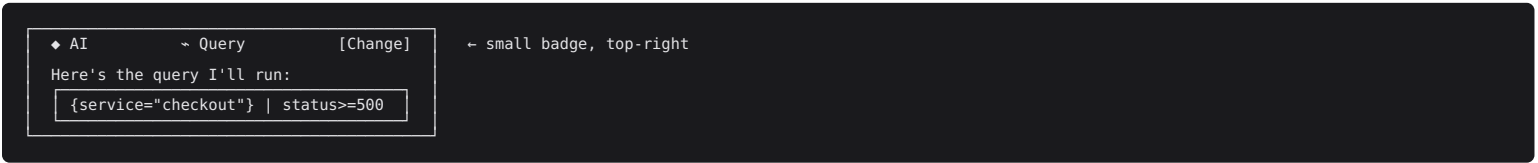
CORE RULE

The mode can be automatic. **Showing the mode cannot be automatic.**

If the AI silently switches to Workflow and starts creating things, the user is lost. So: **detect silently, display visibly, allow correction.**

Where to show it

Put a small badge on the AI's answer, not on the input box.



Badge style: small, muted, `chat/caption` size, uses your `ai/accent` colour. Not loud. The user should notice it only when they look for it.

`[Change]` opens a small menu — *Answer instead / Build a query / Take action*. This is your escape hatch when detection guesses wrong.

Power users can force the mode

Keep slash commands as a manual override. Type `/` in the input and a menu appears.

Command	Forces
<code>/ask</code>	Normal — just answer, do not build anything
<code>/query</code>	Query — write a search for this
<code>/do</code>	Workflow — propose an action

Most users will never touch these. The ones who do will rely on them daily.

When the AI is not sure

Do not guess. Ask with chips.



The one exception: Workflow

Normal → Query switching automatically is safe. Both only *read* data. Worst case is a wasted query.

Workflow **changes real things**. So:

- The AI **may** enter Workflow mode automatically
- The AI **may never** execute automatically

WHY AUTO-DETECTION IS STILL SAFE

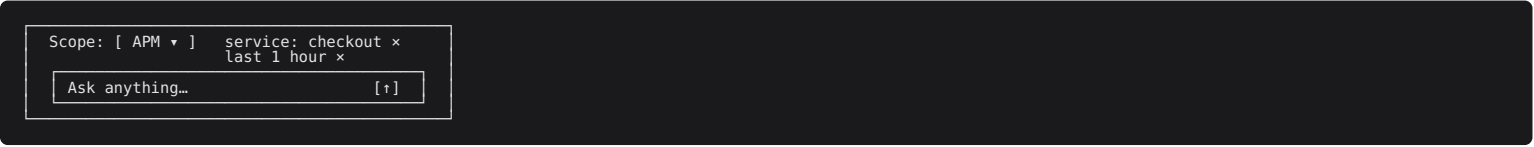
The **approval card** protects the user, not the mode switcher. As long as every action stops at an approval gate, automatic mode detection carries no risk.

```
User: "alert me when checkout errors go above 5%"
  ↓
AI detects Workflow automatically
  ↓
Shows badge: ↗ Workflow
  ↓
Shows the plan + config preview
  ↓
• STOPS. Waits for [ Approve & create ]
```

The user never chose "Workflow mode" — but they still had full control.

Part 2 — Global vs Module scope

This is a **dropdown chip**, sitting in the context bar directly above the input.



Opening the dropdown:



Smart default — this is the important part

Do not make the user choose every time. Set the default from **where they opened the chat**.

User opens chat from	Default scope
Inside the APM module	APM
Inside Logs	Logs
Global top nav / command palette	All modules
An alert card ("Explain this")	Alerts + that alert pinned

The user only touches the dropdown when they want something different — roughly 10% of the time.

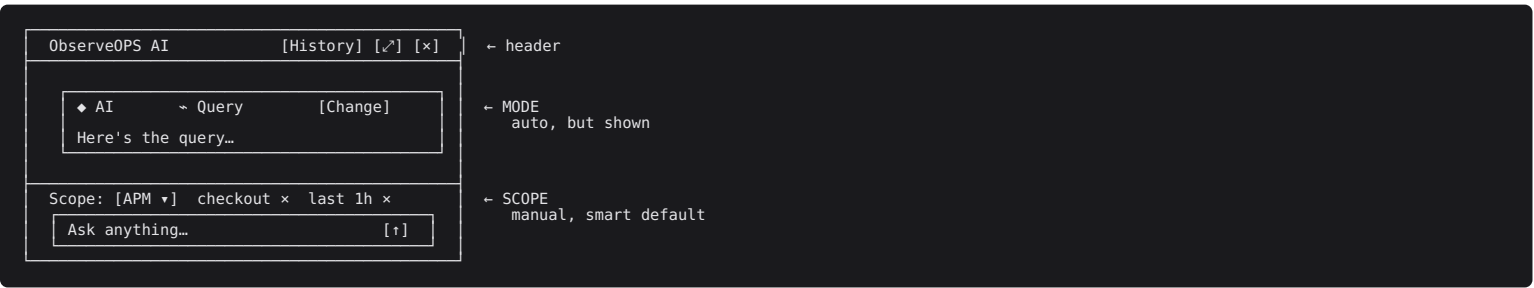
When the scope is wrong, the AI asks

Very common real case: the user is in APM, but asks a question that needs Logs data.

```
This question needs Logs data too. Your scope is set to APM.
[ Expand to Logs + APM ] [ Keep APM only ]
```

Do not silently expand. Do not silently fail. Ask with one chip.

How the two work together



WHY THIS PLACEMENT

Mode lives with the answer, at the top — it describes what already happened.
Scope lives with the input, at the bottom — it describes what will happen next.
This is not decoration. It matches the direction of time on the screen.

Figma file changes

Remove: `ModeSwitcher` (the segmented control). You do not need it anymore.

Add these three components:

Component	Variants	Notes
ModeBadge	normal / query / workflow	Small, muted, sits on the AI message header. Includes a <code>[Change]</code> link.
ModeOverrideMenu	—	Three options, each with a one-line description underneath.
ScopeSelector	global / single-module / multi-module	Dropdown chip inside the context bar.

Add one new state to your existing `ErrorCard` component:

- scope-mismatch** — "This needs Logs data. Expand scope?"